

SELECTED WORK · 2023-2026

Charles Abi Chahine.

architect · computational designer

design, computation, and the work of getting it built.



<https://charlesabichahine.com>

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Sensi.

MACAD 2026 AWARD

A sensory copilot for floor plans: it reads a plan and scores how each room will feel across six coupled senses, personalized to the person who will live in it.

In architecture we model everything: structure, cost, energy, code compliance. Layer after layer that makes a building accountable before it is built. Sensi adds the one layer we never formalized: how a space will actually feel. Not emotion, but the full sensory experience of standing in a room, scored across six senses: thermal, visual, acoustic, spatial, olfactory, tactile. Not in the abstract, but for a specific person.

YEAR

2026

MODULE

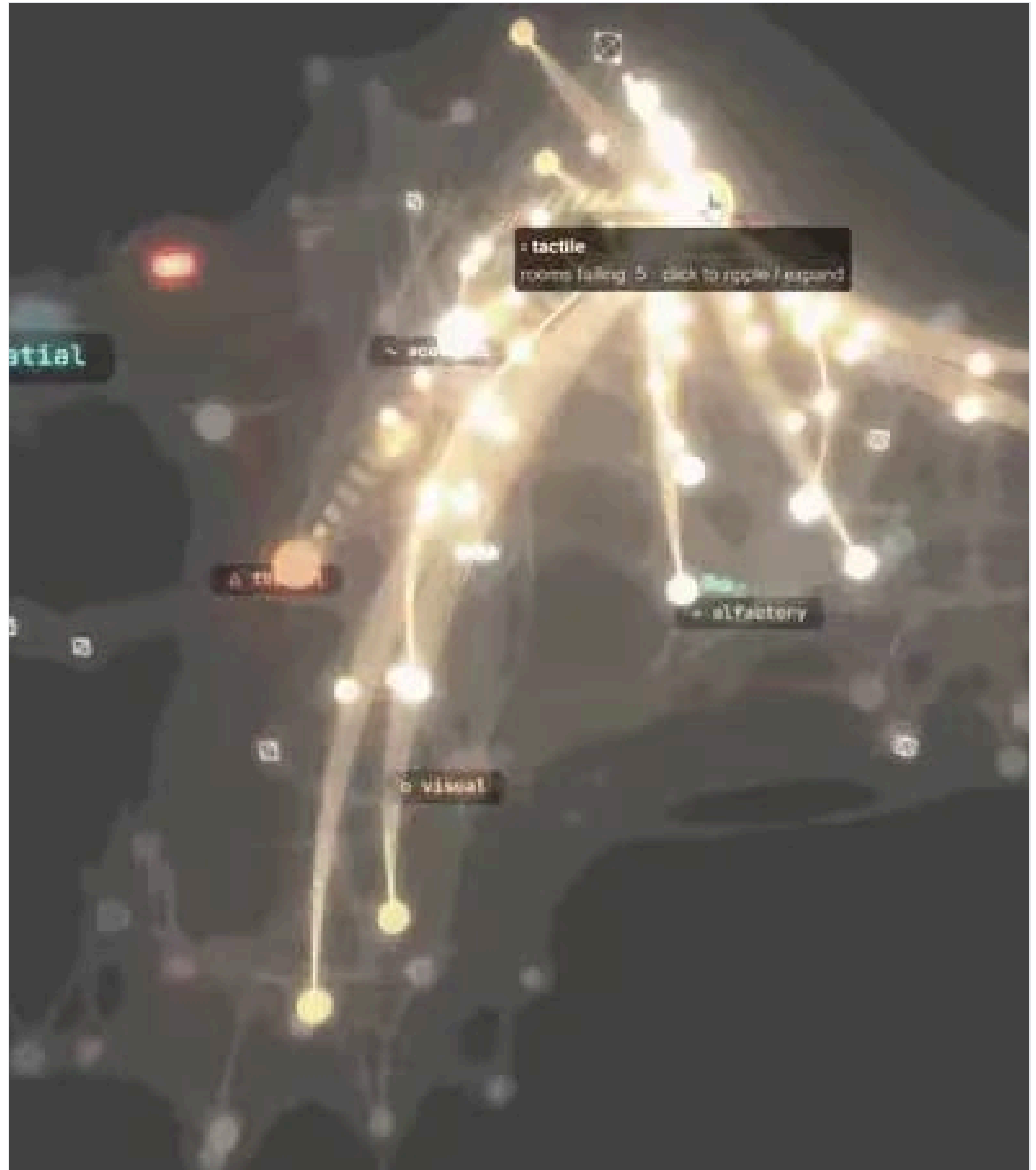
AIA Studio · MaCAD, IAAC

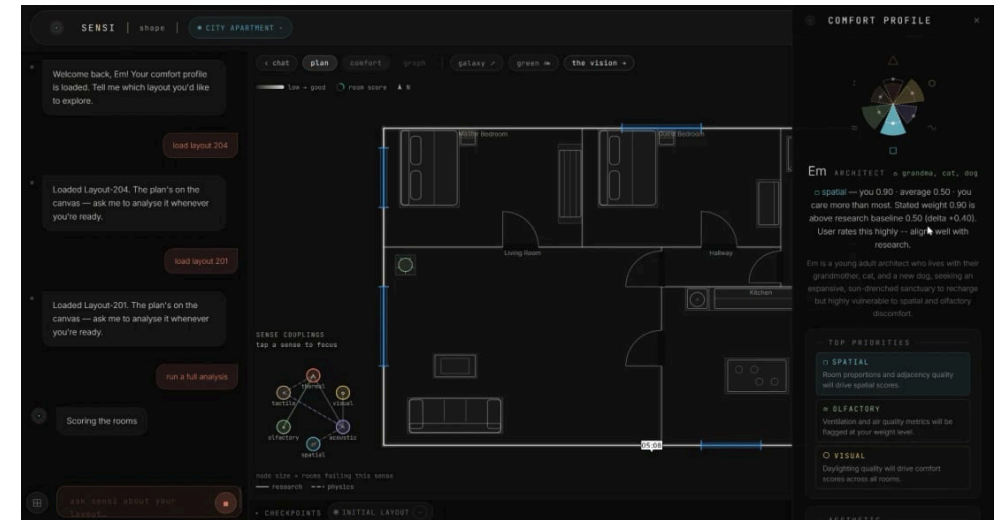
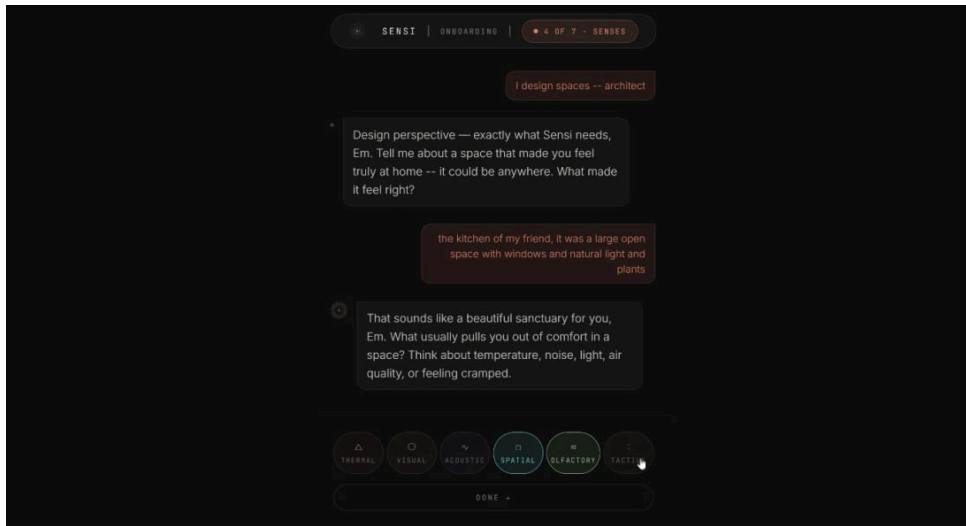
TEAM

Charles Abi Chahine, Emilie El Chidiac, Lakzhmy Mari Zaro, María Sánchez Domínguez

TOOLS

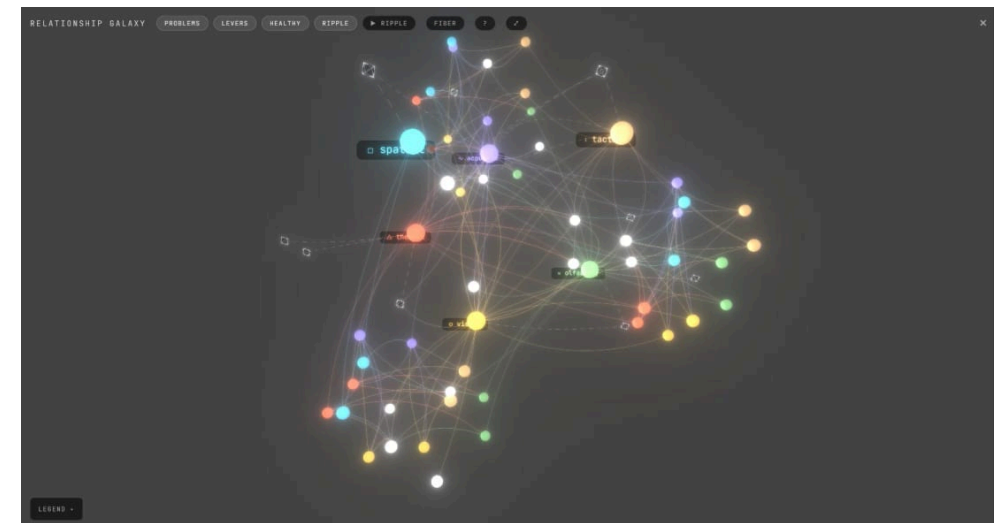
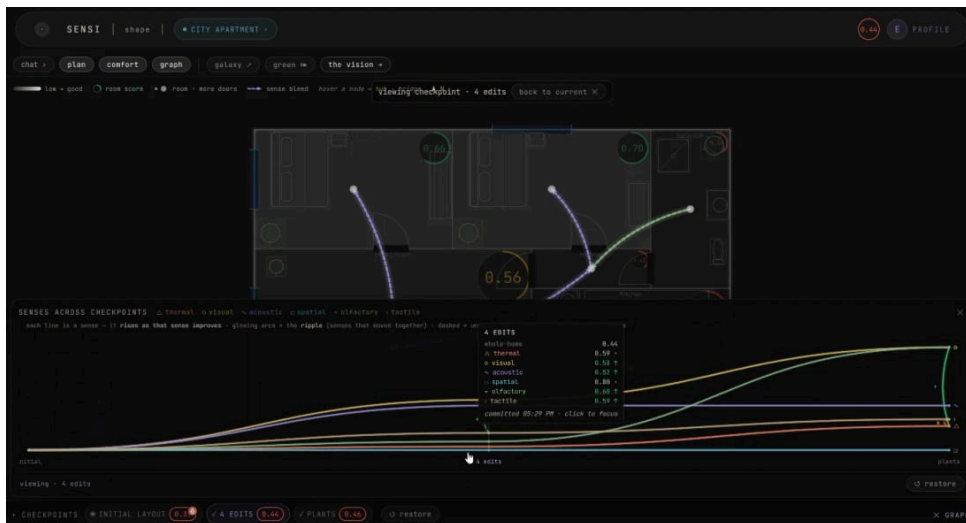
Python · LLM agents · Vision models · Web app





The persona, visualized as a petal rose: your comfort priorities, made explicit.

Reading the plan into rooms, uses, and adjacencies.



Scores respond to every edit, the ripple propagating by fixed rules.

The galaxy view: rooms, senses, and levers as one connected system.

IEgoarCh.

IAAC EXHIBITION

From a one-sentence prompt to a priced, buildable LEGO set: generative AI proposes the form, deterministic computation proves it stands.

You type a building, and a minute later a real LEGO set is sitting on a shelf: rendered, modelled, brick-built, priced, and catalog-legal. Most "AI makes LEGO" demos stop at a gorgeous render, but a render is a promise, not a product. IEgoarCh builds the downstream half: the machinery that forces the dream to obey real bricks, real colours, and real gravity.

YEAR

2026

MODULE

Generative AI Seminar ·
MaCAD, IAAC

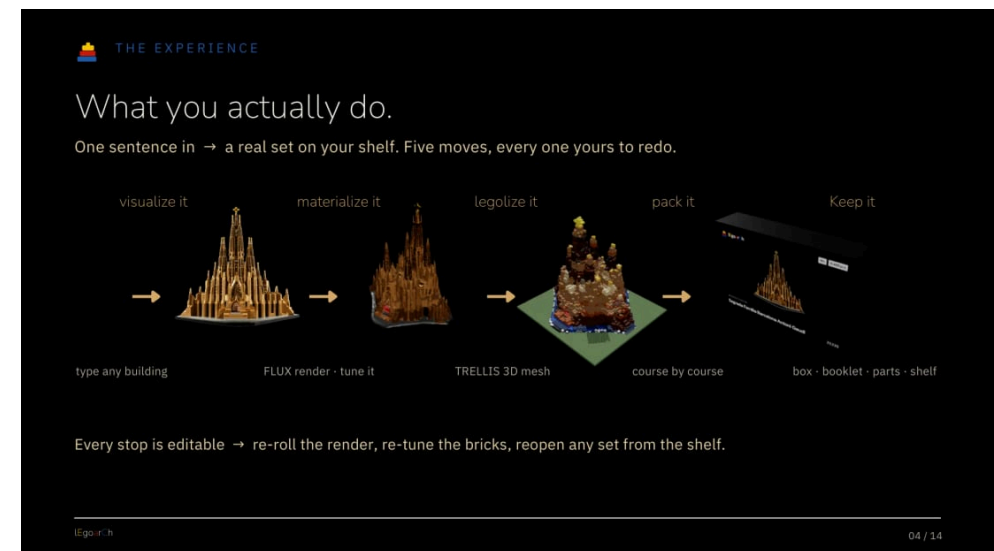
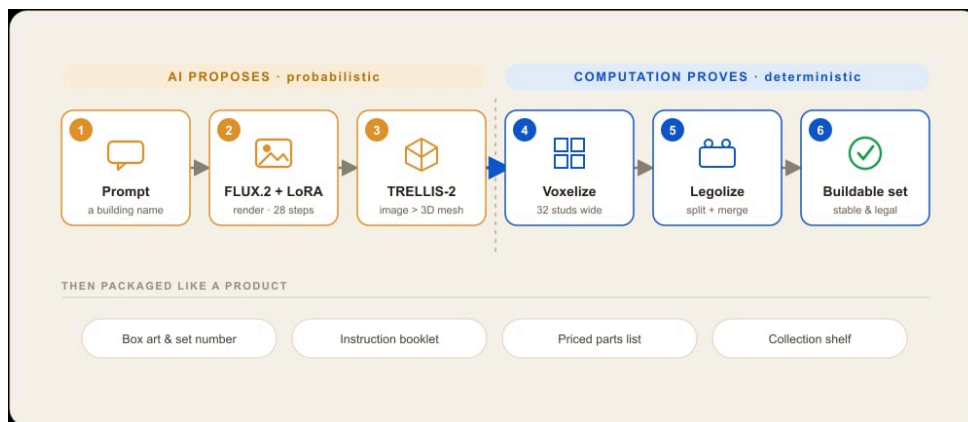
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TOOLS

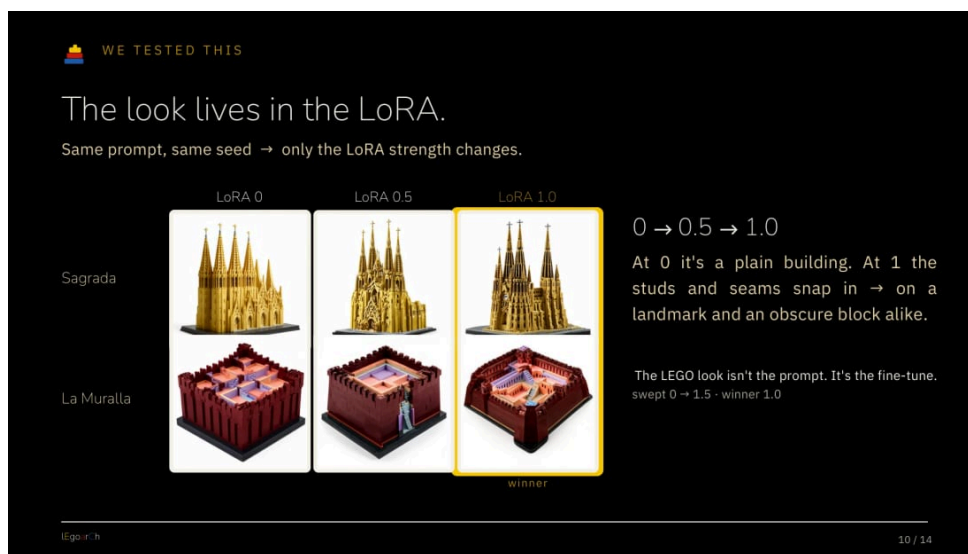
FLUX.2 + LoRA · TRELLIS-2 · ComfyUI · Python





The whole pipeline on one line: three probabilistic boxes, then three deterministic ones.

The five-move experience: visualize, materialize, legolize, pack, keep.



Same prompt, same seed, only the LoRA strength changes. 1.0 wins.



FLUX.2 + the legoarch LoRA rendering the Sagrada Família as an official-set photo.

Analyzing Narkomfin Through Its Graph.

The Narkomfin Building rebuilt as a spatial graph: centrality and community detection recover Ginzburg's vertical living cells from topology alone, and a GraphSAGE classifier reads room types the plan cannot show.

The Narkomfin Building (Moscow, 1930) is reconstructed as a spatial graph to analyse what floor plans cannot show. Grid sampling and stair stitching connect both apartment types into weighted networks; closeness and betweenness centrality expose the corridor as the building's sole topological spine. Community detection recovers Ginzburg's intended vertical living cells from topology alone, and a GraphSAGE room-type classifier scores 68% on the communal Type K layout: confirming the building deliberately breaks domestic spatial conventions.

YEAR

2026

MODULE

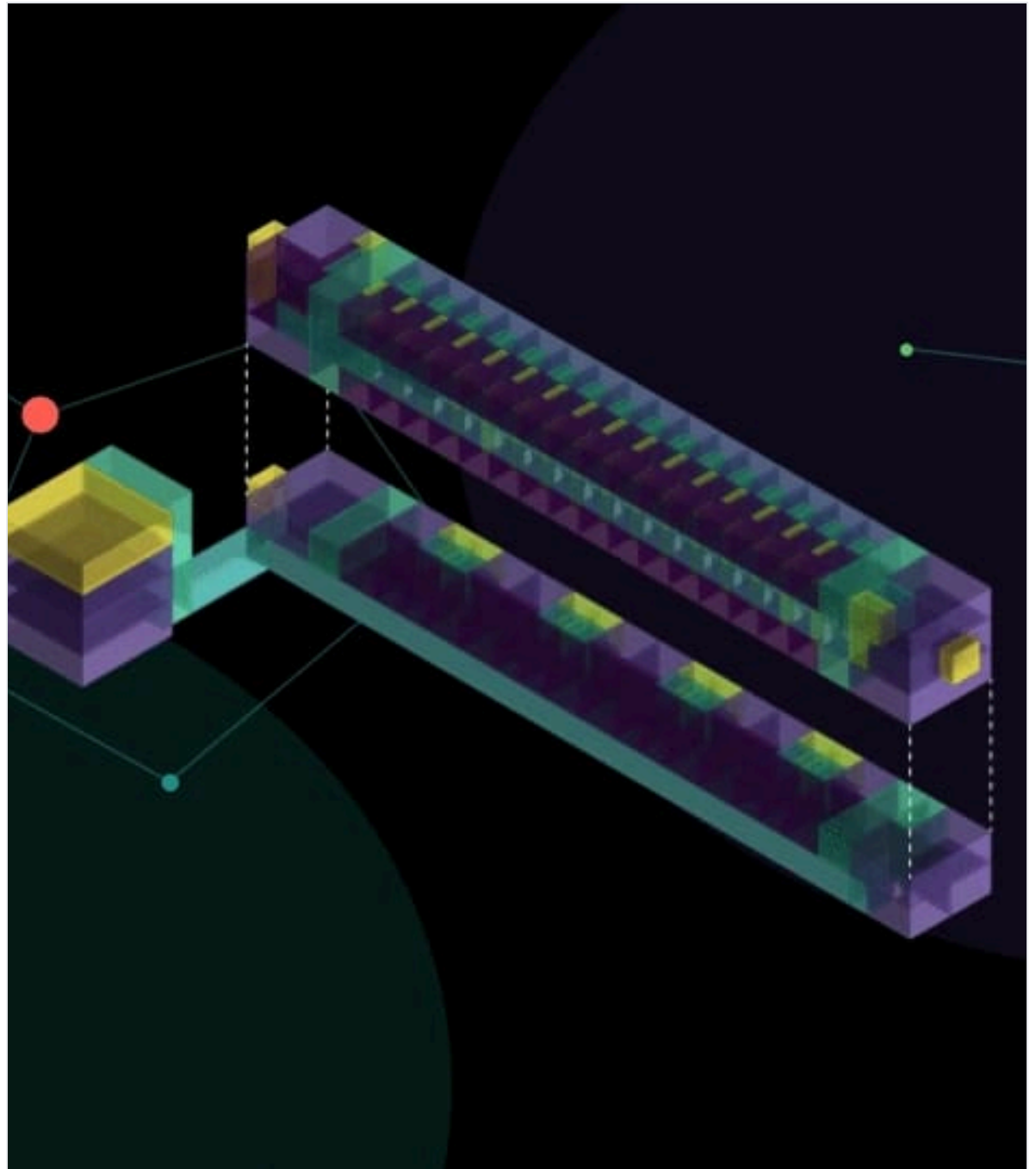
Graph Machine Learning ·
MaCAD, IAAC

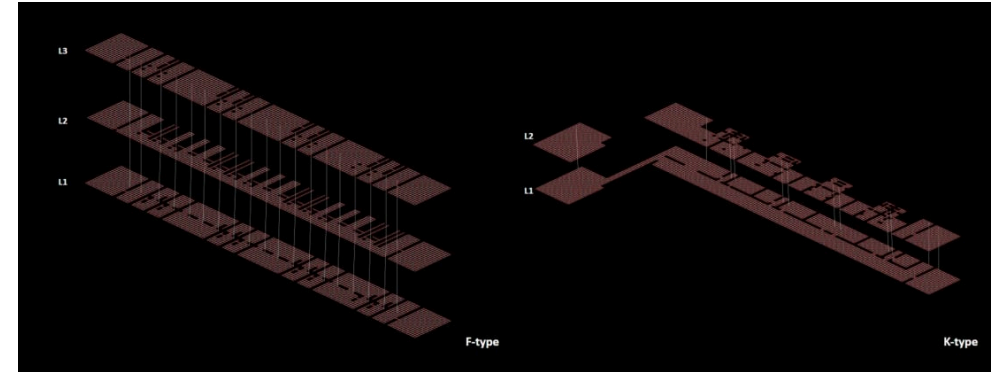
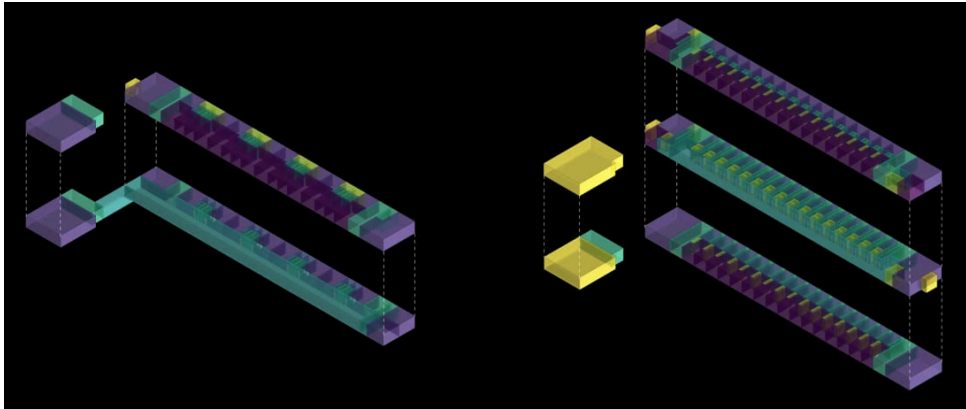
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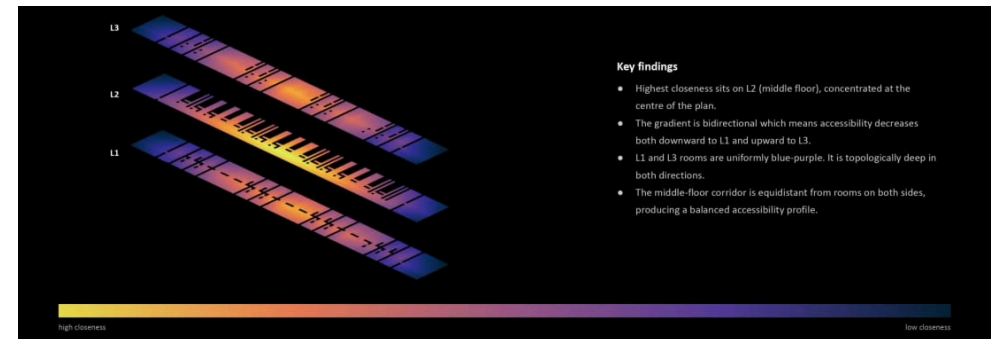
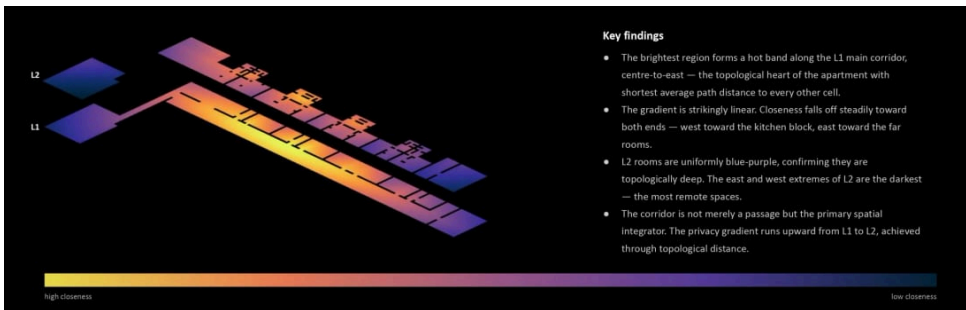
Python · GraphSAGE · Graph ML





Both apartment types exploded by level. Type K is a two-storey duplex, Type F a three-storey unit for singles, and the corridor sits at a different height in each.

Both types sampled on a 0.5-unit grid and stitched across floors at the stairs. Type K is asymmetric, one dense floor and one fragmented; Type F is symmetric, sparse-dense-sparse.



Type K. The hot band runs the length of the L1 corridor and accessibility falls off in one direction only, upward into the rooms.

Type F. Closeness peaks on the middle floor and drops both downward and upward, a balanced privacy gradient rather than a one-way one.

Encoding Urban Risk.

A machine-learning pipeline that classifies London street segments into low, medium, and high morphological-risk typologies from public spatial data alone, then tests whether the reading survives a move to another city.

Can the physical layout of a street, measurable from public map data, predict how risky it feels? We framed it as a three-class problem: low, medium, or high risk, using seven spatial features drawn from OpenStreetMap and Mapillary per street segment. This is the full arc of the project, not just the results, but the wrong turn that made them honest.

YEAR

2026

MODULE

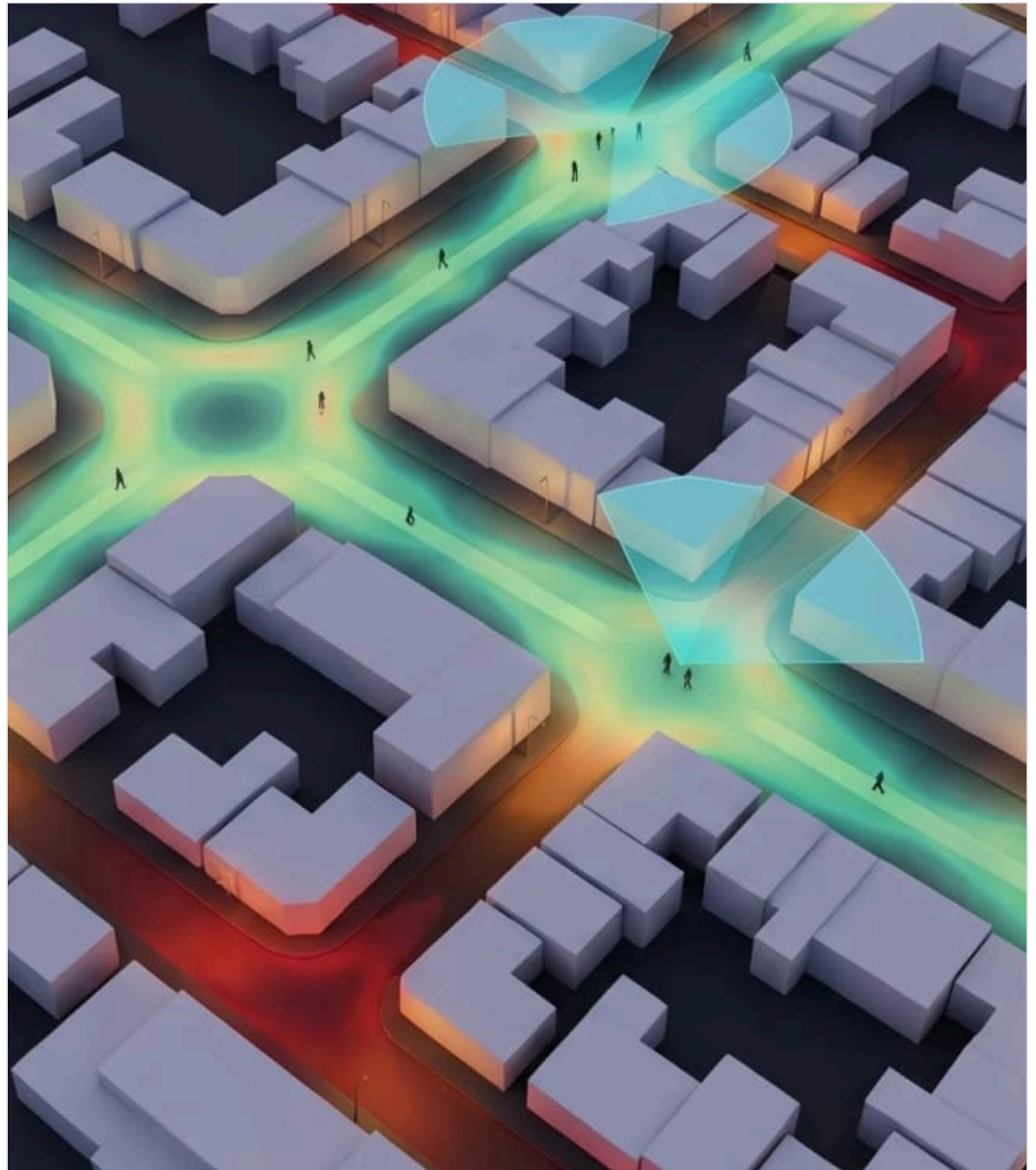
Data Encoding · MaCAD, IAAC

TEAM

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TOOLS

Python · scikit-learn · OpenStreetMap · Mapillary · SHAP





Eyes on the street, active frontages, mixed uses & foot traffic create natural surveillance.



Offenders strike within their awareness space — familiar routes and nodes.



Territorial control, restricted access. Small recognisable communities self-police.



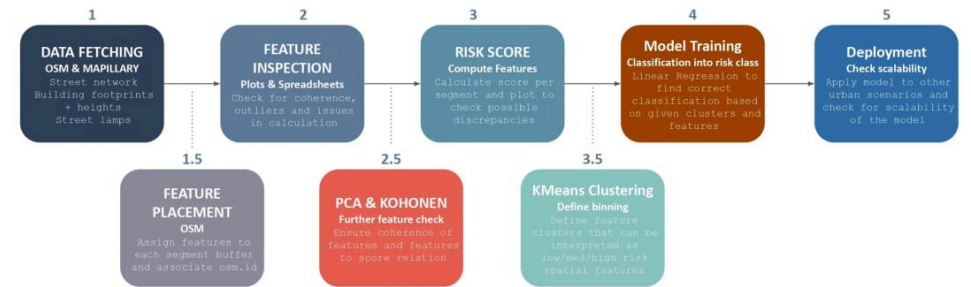
Residential density neutralises risk. Safety in numbers confirmed across 65,000+ dwellings.



Street configuration shapes movement, encounter and territorial control — Space Syntax.



Global Choice is the strongest single predictor. Crime spills within 100 m of major routes.



Seven features, each anchored in a lineage of urban-safety theory.

RISK_SCORE

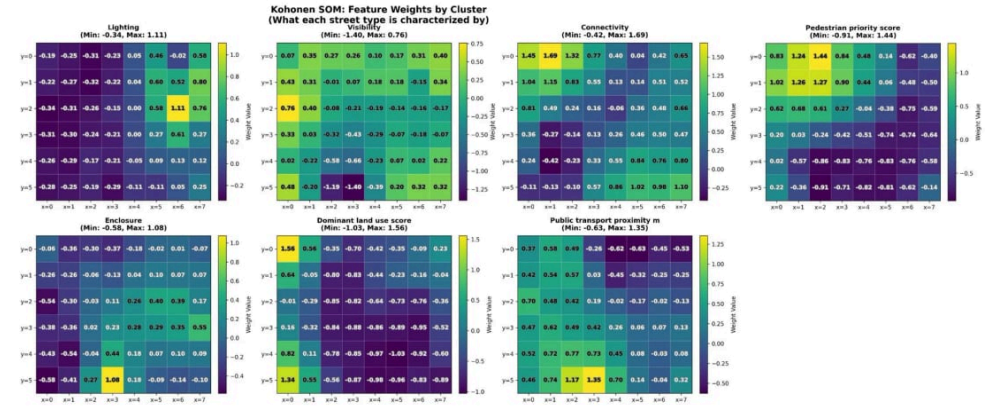
$$\sum \text{Risk_Score}(\text{segment}): \sum (\text{lighting}) * f0 + \sum (\text{visibility}) * f1 + \sum (\text{connectivity}) * f2 + \sum (\text{enclosure}) * f3 + \sum (\text{transport}) * f4 + \sum (\text{landuse}) * f5 + \sum (\text{ppi}) * f6$$

*All features are normalized

location_id	lighting	visibility	connectivity	enclosure	public transport p.	dom. land use	ped. priority score
ISL_16527_-27061	0.00	0.55	9	0.21	36.61	0.67	0.49
ISL_16528_-27064	0.00	0.52	8	0.20	68.36	0.65	0.49
ISL_16683_-27082	11.87	0.72	12	0.40	73.38	0.14	0.52
ISL_16683_-27079	6.90	0.71	8	0.33	63.01	0.26	0.65
ISL_16687_-27079	4.12	0.69	12	0.33	24.33	0.25	0.52
ISL_16691_-27076	7.02	0.68	12	0.38	40.66	0.39	0.52
ISL_16691_-27079	2.09	0.65	11	0.34	27.5	0.32	0.59
ISL_16687_-27079	4.12	0.69	12	0.33	24.33	0.25	0.52
ISL_16695_-27084	4.38	0.71	11	0.34	99.88	0.14	0.59
ISL_16696_-27087	2.87	0.70	12	0.36	136.74	0.06	0.59
ISL_16701_-27082	4.40	0.75	13	0.27	132.73	0.16	0.53
ISL_16621_-27066	0.00	0.76	12	0.27	46.35	0.04	0.59
ISL_16616_-27068	0.00	0.73	10	0.10	10	0.13	0.59
ISL_16621_-27062	0.81	0.74	12	0.16	2.21	0.05	0.59
ISL_16658_-27108	4.22	0.75	13	0.17	31.78	0.39	0.53
ISL_16657_-27112	0.00	0.70	14	0.31	28.79	0.42	0.52
ISL_16663_-27115	0.00	0.75	12	0.24	16.04	0.29	0.56

f0 = -0.30
f1 = -0.20
f2 = +0.10
f3 = +0.20
f4 = +0.20
f5 = +0.10
f6 = -0.15

The wall: every model flat against the diagonal. Crime does not reduce to spatial features.



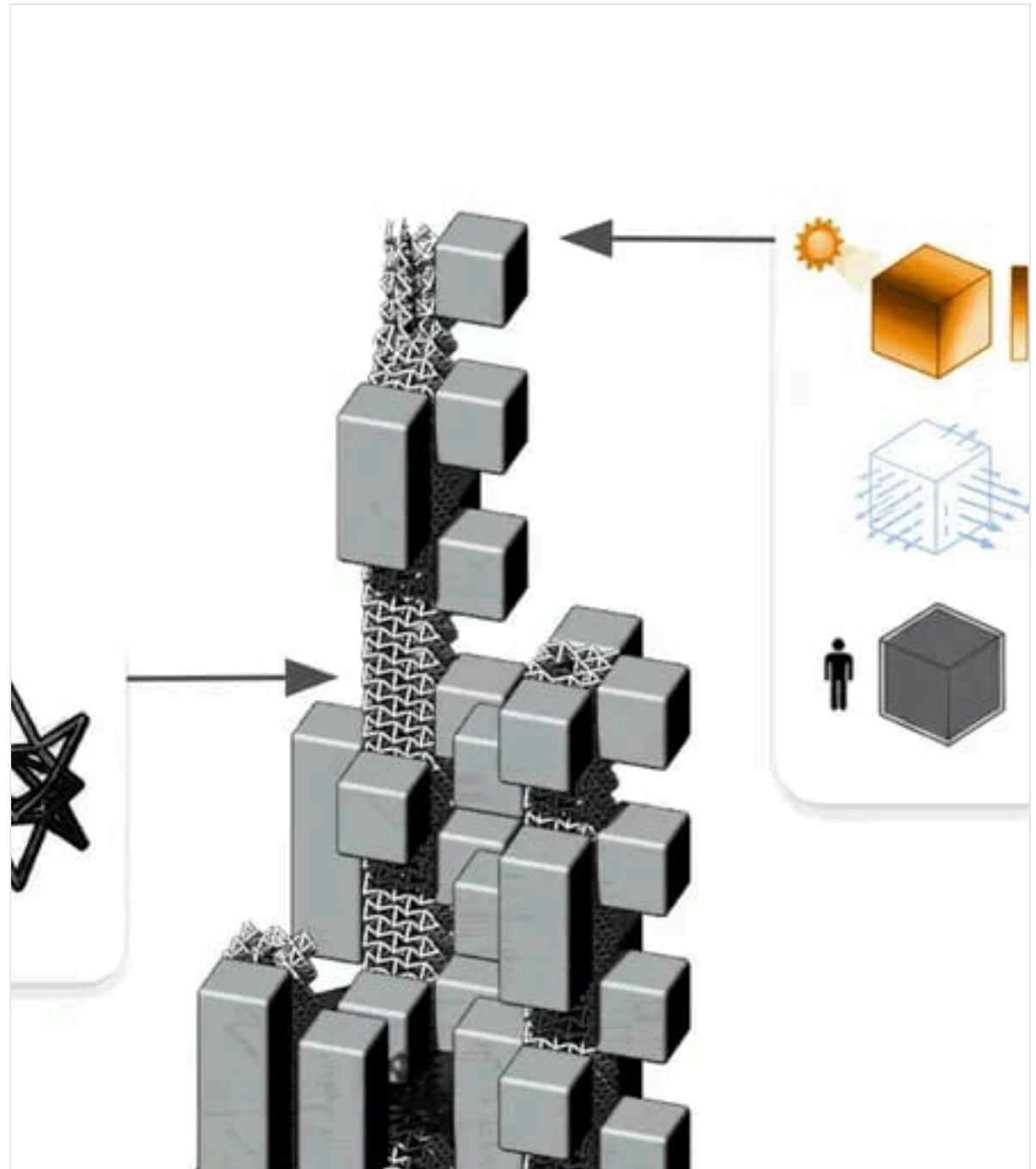
The eight-step pipeline: from OSM features to a deployable classifier.

Redundancy check: the one strong correlation is visibility vs. enclosure at -0.75.

Breathing Mass.

A hyperbuilding for Santiago conceived as a vertical lung: a tower that captures, cleans, and redistributes the city's polluted air through a breathing core, resolved as a topology-optimized structure and a performance-driven facade.

Breathing Mass is a vertical ecosystem in Santiago where architecture, wind, and energy converge. The Hyper Lung captures, cleans, and redistributes polluted air through a breathing core, turning the tower into living infrastructure that breathes with the city. Within a larger hyperbuilding studio, our team owned its structure and facade: translating the lung analogy into a self-braced skeleton and an adaptive skin, every form justified by data and published to the program and data teams through Speckle.



YEAR

2026

MODULE

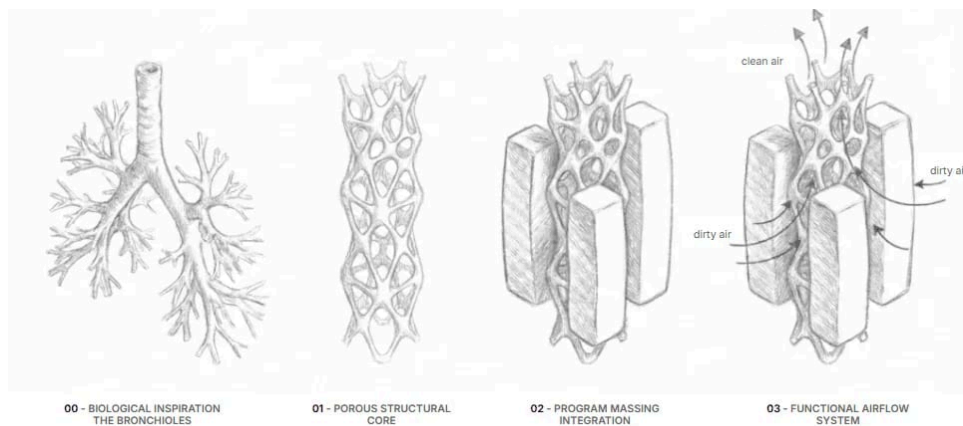
BIMSC Studio • MaCAD, IAAC

TEAM

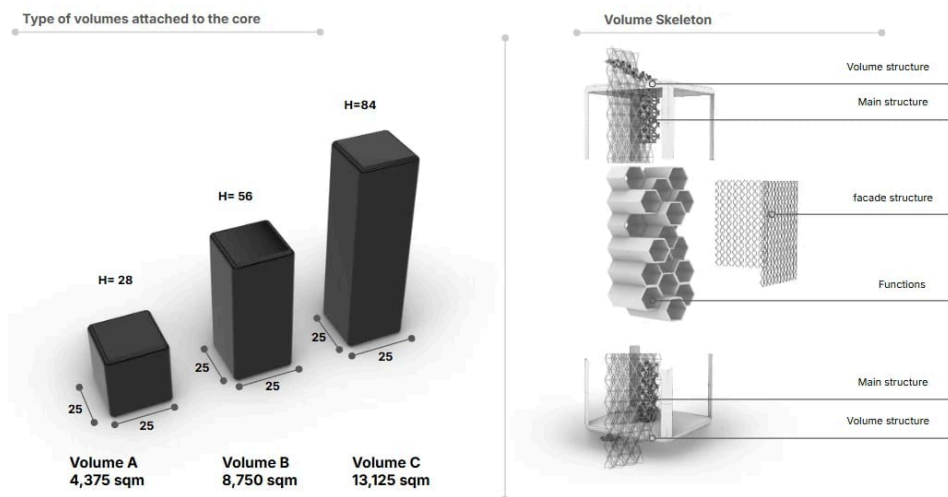
Charles Abi Chahine, Ramy Ayoub, Hani Karime

TOOLS

Rhino • Grasshopper • Alpaca • Speckle

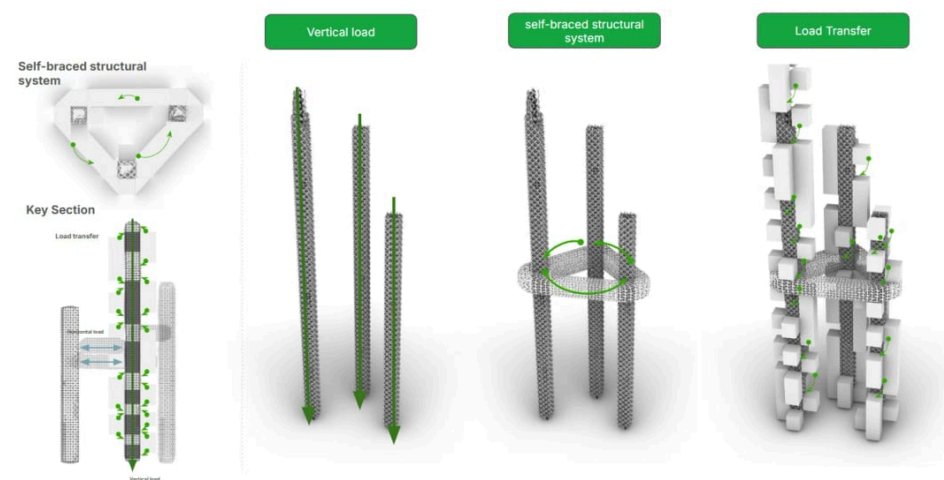


From bronchi to a porous structural core: the lung analogy driving the spine.

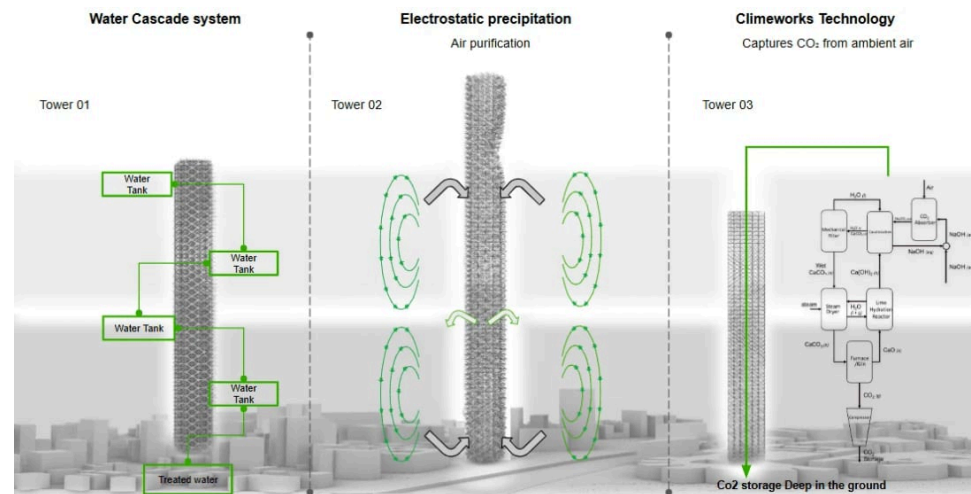


Volume scattering: candidate masses evaluated by radiation, wind, and density.

05 · BREATHING MASS



Self-braced structural system: load transfer from plugged volumes through the triangulated cores.



The environmental machine: water cascade, electrostatic precipitation, and CO2 capture.

The Huddle.

IAAC EXHIBITION

A wind-adaptive research & education hub with expedition basecamp in Punta Arenas, Chile: discrete modules aggregated against a perpetually windy subpolar climate.

Punta Arenas sits at the southern tip of Chile in a cold, perpetually windy subpolar climate. The Huddle is a research and education hub with an expedition basecamp for 1,000 users, designed the way penguins survive the same latitudes: compact forms, packed close, shielding one another from the wind.



YEAR

2025/26

MODULE

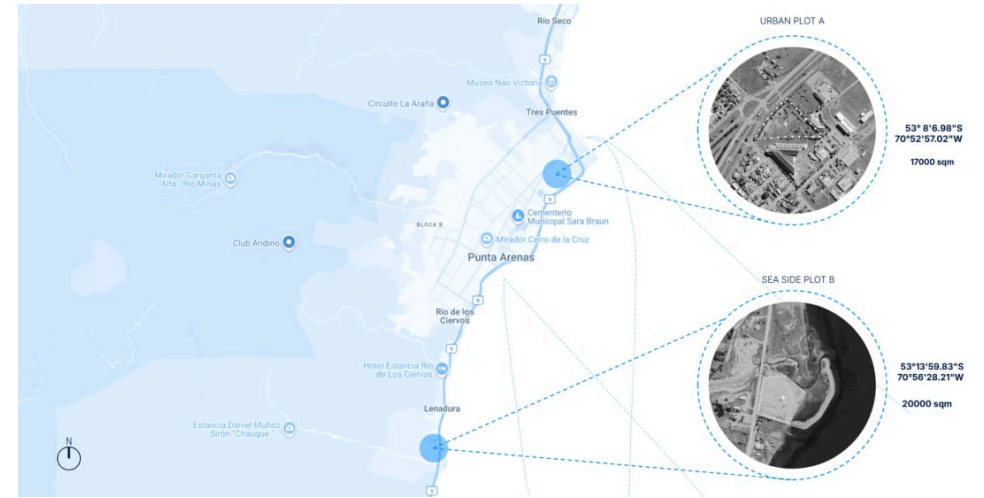
ACESD Studio · MaCAD, IAAC

TEAM

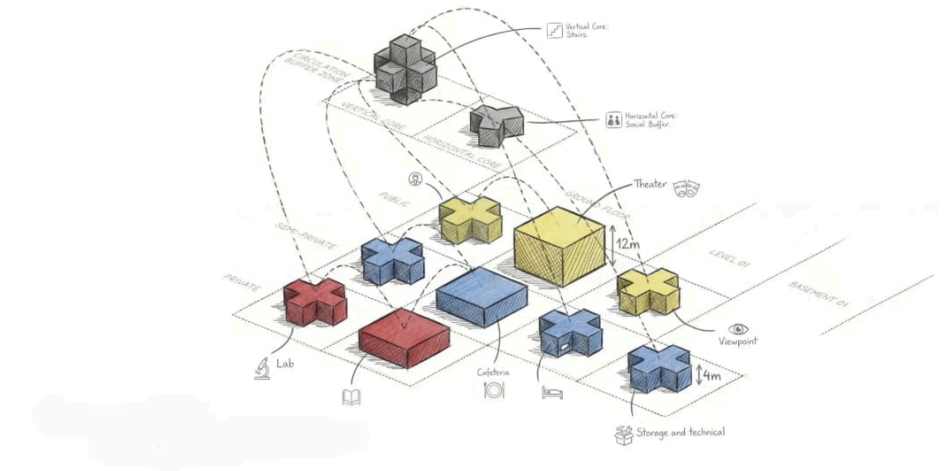
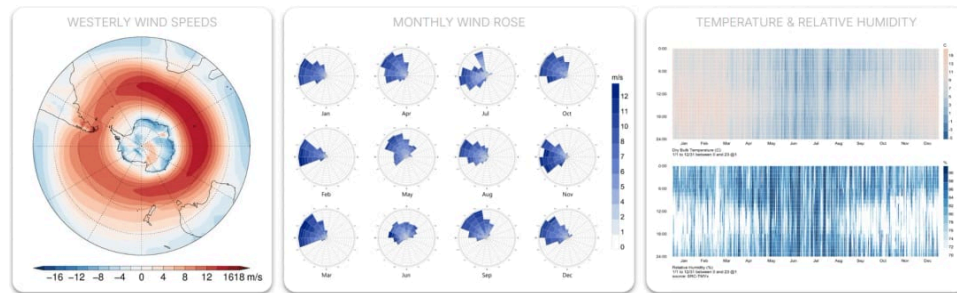
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TOOLS

Rhino · Grasshopper · Wasp · Kangaroo · Speckle



The two plots we compared: an urban plot of 17,000 m² inside the city and a seafront plot of 20,000 m² on the strait.



The kit of parts across three levels: cross modules for general functions, reinforced cores for circulation, triangular connectors, and the 12 m theatre volume, coloured private, semi-private and public.

Westerly wind speeds across the southern hemisphere, the monthly wind rose, and a year of dry-bulb temperature and relative humidity.

The Luminous Stratum.

A “volume of sedimented light” inserted into Cairo’s historic fabric: an independent lattice that hovers within a market void, filtering the harsh sun without ever touching the historic walls.

In the dense historic fabric of Cairo, light is both a blessing and a burden. The Luminous Stratum proposes a new architectural language that negotiates this relationship: a “volume of sedimented light” that mimics the city’s stratification while filtering the harsh sun. Designed for the Complex Forming seminar, it is an independent system of stacked lamellas that hovers within the void of the Bab Al-Luk historic market, leaving the original structure untouched.

YEAR

2025

MODULE

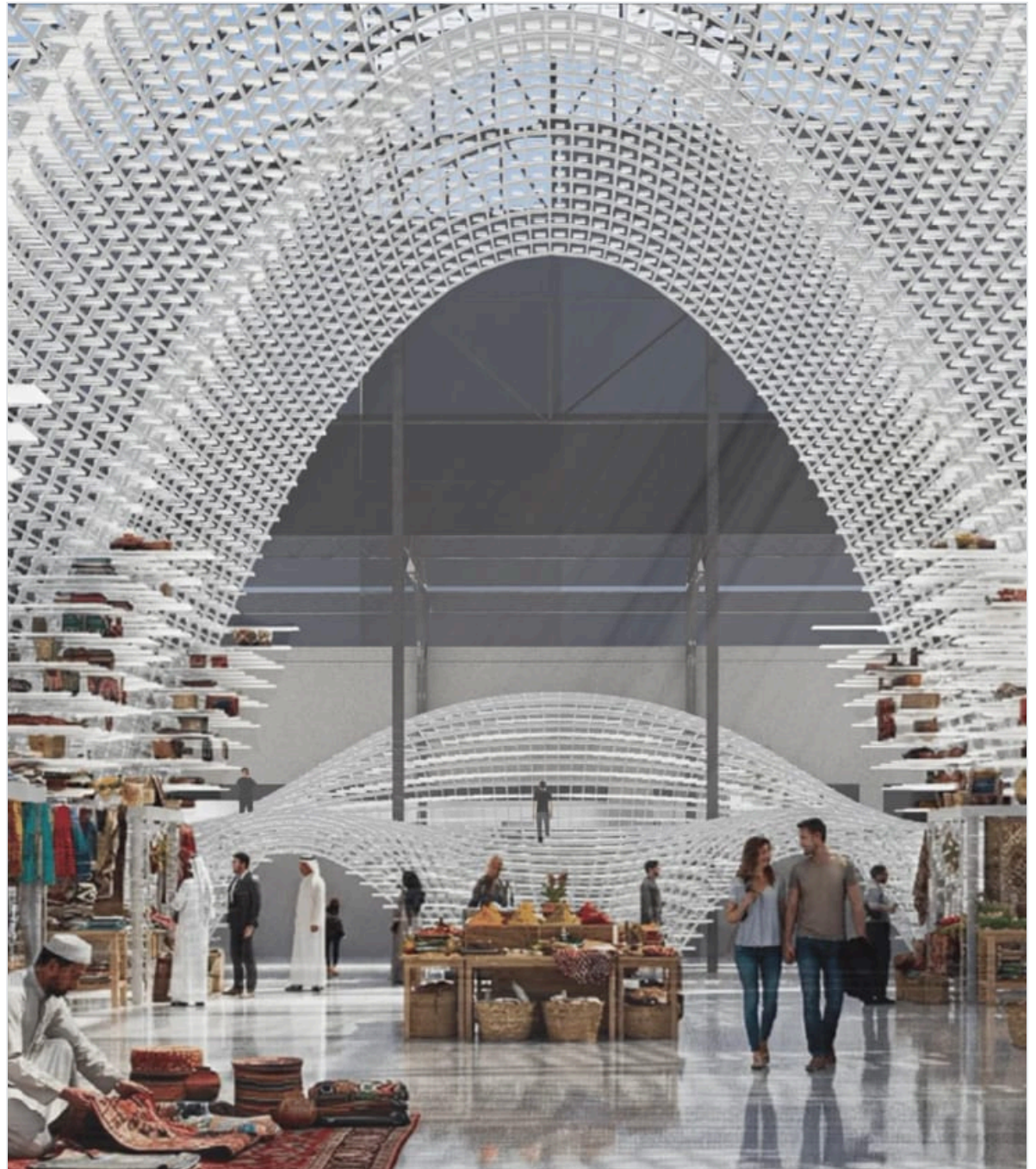
Complex Forming • MaCAD, IAAC

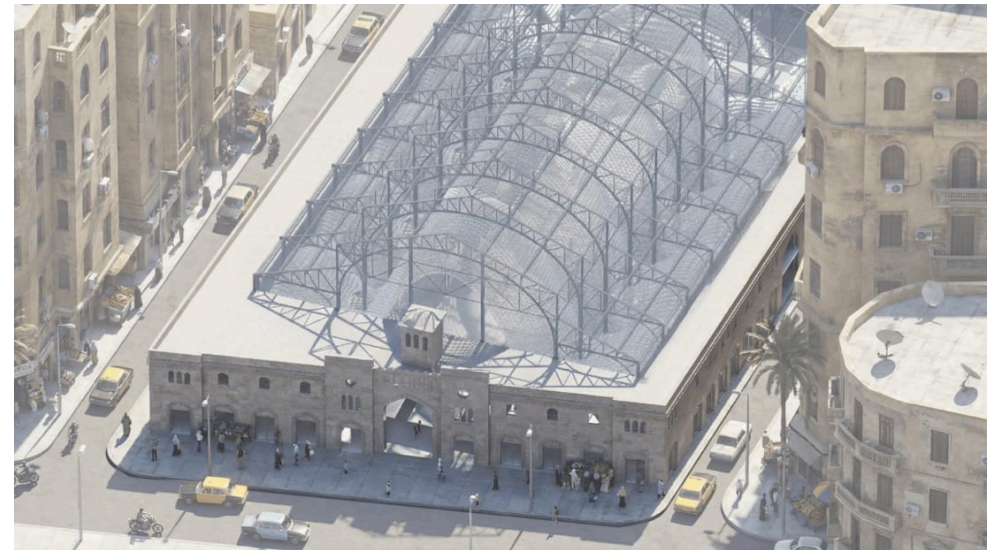
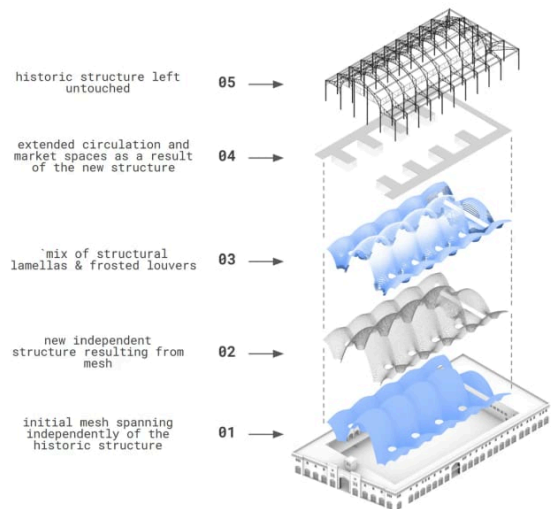
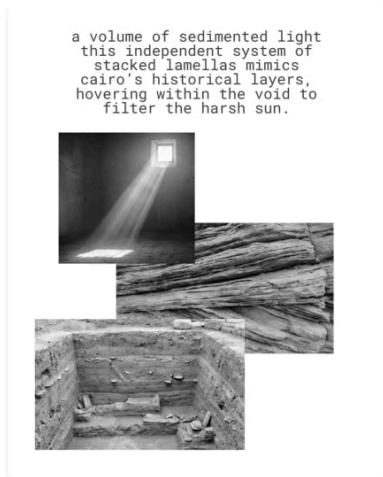
TEAM

Charles Abi Chahine

TOOLS

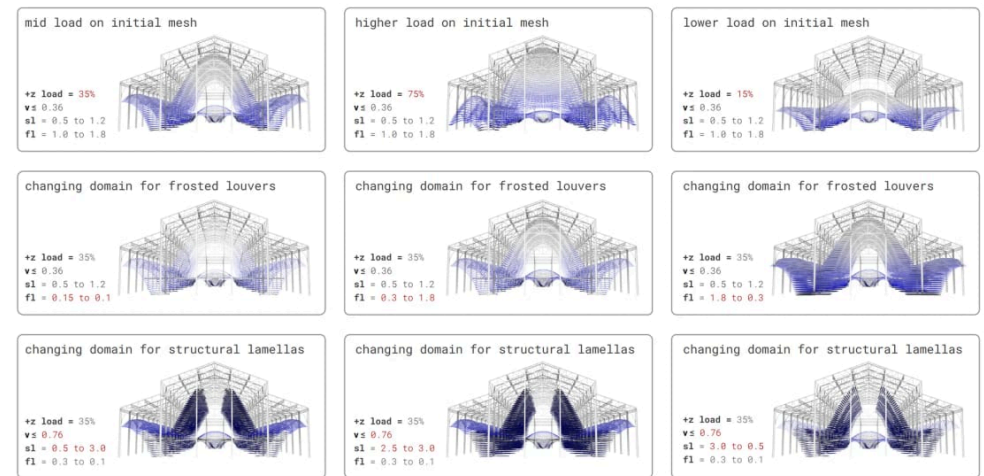
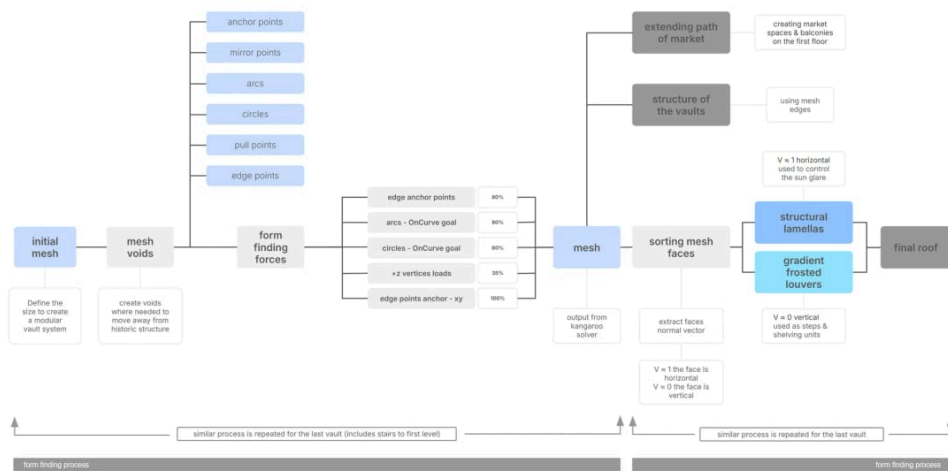
Rhino • Grasshopper • Kangaroo





A volume of sedimented light: an independent system layered above the untouched historic market.

The lattice hovering within the historic market hall.



The computational logic: anchor points, form-finding forces, and the sorting of mesh faces.

Iterating vertical loads and louver/lamella domains to balance shading against structure.

Point Nought.

My bachelor final-year thesis at LAU: reimagining the coastal town of Anfeh in North Lebanon through its landscape of salt ponds, fishing, and olives.

Point Nought is my final-year thesis at the Lebanese American University (Spring 2023), advised by Issam Barhouch and Omar Harb, and shown at the LAU final-projects exhibition. Anfeh has a lot to offer — salt ponds along the coast, agricultural land, a living fishing culture — and the thesis commemorates that long-living heritage: restoring the salinas not just to rebuild, but to build a narrative around a degrading tradition, and to give the town a base for the visitors who come to learn it.

YEAR

2023

MODULE

B.Arch Final Year Project •
LAU

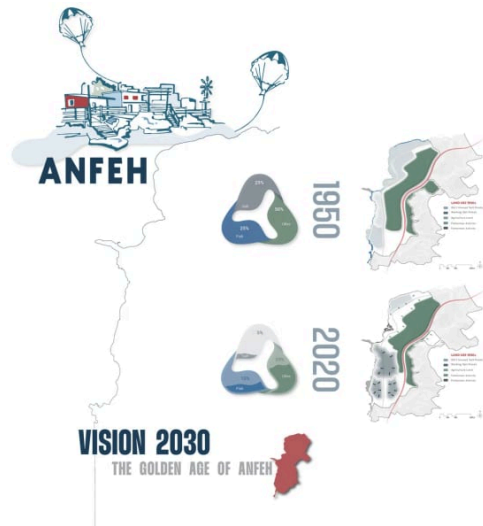
TEAM

Charles Abi Chahine

TOOLS

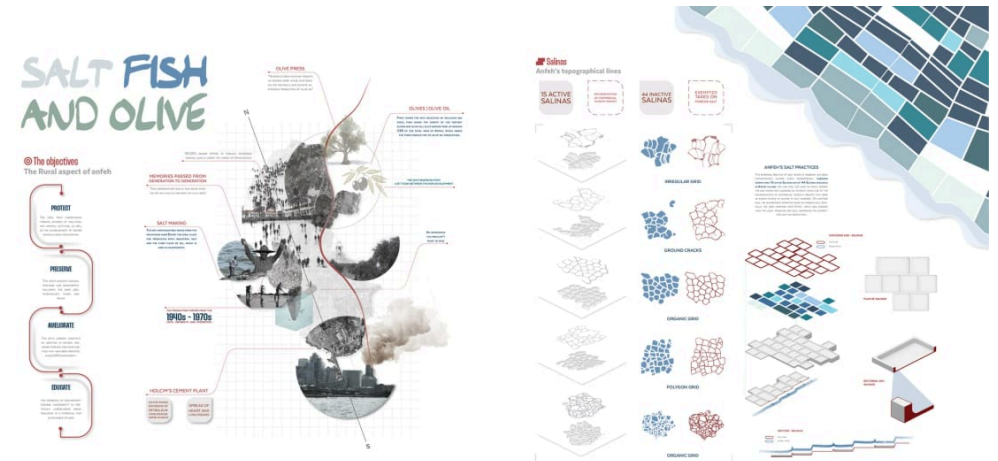
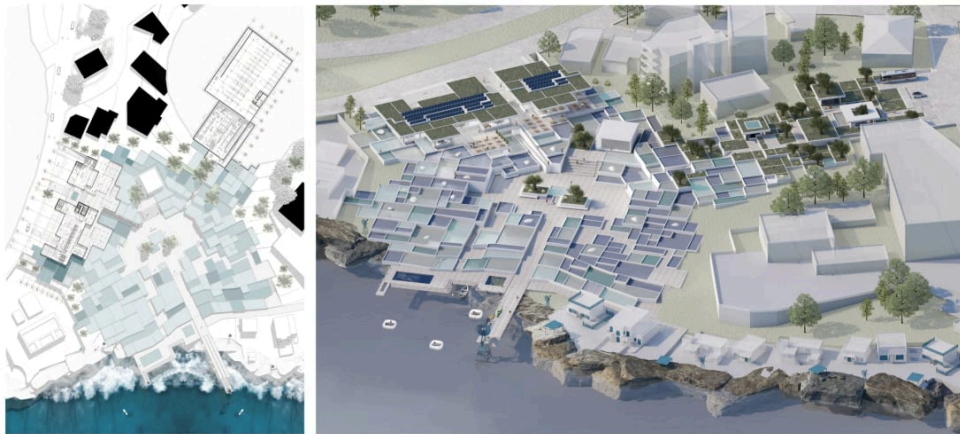
Architecture • Urban design





Anfeh's land use in 1950 and 2020 — salt 25% to 5%, fish 25% to 10%, olive 50% to 35% — and the Vision 2030 the thesis answers.

Point Nought at dusk: the wind wheel over the restored ponds, bathers on the salt terraces.



The masterplan and its aerial: the village grid stepping down to the ponds along the extended footpath.

Salt, fish and olive: the objectives for each tradition, and the tile grammar drawn from the salt-pond grid.

THE REST OF IT

Eighteen projects, four belts.

This booklet is a selection. Every project, with its full gallery and write-up, is on the site.